

Ad-hoc Mode

Also known as peer-to-peer mode or IBSS. Ad-hoc mode lets wirelessly networked devices communicate directly, without going through an access point or other intermediary.

Adapter

An adapter is a device that connects to your computer and adds a capability or feature. The most common example is a circuit board, such as a graphics card or an NIC, that installs into an expansion slot on a computer's motherboard. Such an add-on board is also known as an expansion board. The SmartCard reader you plug into a USB port to download photos from your digital camera, or the cradle you use to synchronise your PDA with your desktop, can also be called adapters.

AES

Advanced Encryption Standard. AES is a data encryption scheme that beats both DES and 3DES by using three different key sizes—128-bit, 192-bit, and 256-bit, but with only one encryption step to encrypt data in 128-bit blocks. It is based upon the Rijndael algorithm created by Joan Daemen and Vincent Rijmen of Belgium. AES was adopted by the US government in 2002 as the encryption standard for protecting sensitive but unclassified electronic data. With the arrival of AES, the US officially phased out DES except for in legacy systems.

Antenna Gain

This refers to an antenna's transmission power as a ratio of its output (send) signal strength to its input (receive) signal strength. Antenna gain is usually expressed in dBi - the higher the dBi, the stronger the antenna.

Bandwidth

Refers to data-carrying capacity on a transmission path—how much and how fast data flows. It can apply to network connections, system buses, or any 'pipe' through which data flows. Bandwidth is usually measured in bits or bytes per second. Low-